

Intro - Current Problems - High Divorce rates in China.

This month (May 2021) the government took measures for a 'cooling off period' when a divorce is filed, to stop impulsive divorces

- 70 per cent of the people asking for divorce are women.

1. What do you think could help a marriage succeed????

suggestions....

1.1 Common advice on having a good marriage:

- a. (Yantai - Wen YiYi 好婚姻的秘诀, 就是 “相互成全”. “help each other succeed”

- b. A writer in the field of relationships said: 作家, 情感领域创作者:
一个字: 忍。 One word: Persevere

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- c. General advice: 努力 - Hard work, 优质时间 quality time, 陪伴 - being together, 尊重 - respect, 健康的沟通 healthy communication, 6. 妥协 compromise 7. 宽恕 forgive kuānshù. 欣赏, enjoyment, 亲密关系 close relationship, 友谊 friendship 12. 支持 support 信任 trust,

2. God wants Christians to learn to live the way God does

not only in marriage but in all the areas of our lives.

Eph 5:1–2 Follow God's example, therefore, as dearly loved children 2 and **walk in the way of love**, just as Christ loved us and gave himself up for us as a fragrant offering and sacrifice to God.

所以，你们该效法 神，好像蒙慈爱的儿女一样。 2 也要凭爱心行事，正如基督爱我们，为我们舍了自己，当作馨香的供物和祭物，献与 父

The main purpose of life for a Christian is to try to live the way that Christ did. This changes the main purpose of marriage.

It is one of the best ways to learn to be more like Christ

His self-sacrificing love

His humble service to others.

His patience with followers when they sin

2.1. Jesus , though being God, still revealed himself as a servant

Luke 22:27 For **who is greater**, the one who is at the table or the one who serves? Is it not the one who is at the table? But I am among you as one who serves.

是谁为大？ 是坐席的呢？ 是服事人的呢？ 不是坐席的大吗？ 然而， 我在你们中间如同服事人的。

When the Fireproof movie began,

* The wife complained about the man not serving her needs.

• The man made the same complaint about his wife.

♥ The man **learned to serve** when his wife's heart was closed

2.2. God wants us to carry the burdens of others!

Gal 6:2

Carry each other's burdens, and in this way you will fulfill the law of Christ.

加拉太书 6:2

如此， 就完全了基督的律法。 你们各人的重担要互相担当。

- This means we need to learn the value of people even when they are difficult, selfish, or causing trouble.
- This means we need to learn to give them God's kind of love.
- We can also learn to develop this kind of attitude when we are single. We can learn to respect those co-workers, parents, brothers or sisters, or people in the church whom we disagree with.

Did the couple in Fireproof start off with this attitude?

3. Specific Instructions for Marriage

3.1 Both wife and husband are required to work hard to love.

1 Pet 3:1 Wives, in the same way submit yourselves to your own husbands so that, if any of them do not believe the word, they may be <u>won over without words</u> by the behavior of their wives, 2 when they see the purity and reverence of your lives. 3 Your beauty should not come from outward adornment, such as elaborate hairstyles and the wearing of gold jewelry or fine clothes. 4 Rather, it should be that of your inner self, <u>the unfading beauty of a gentle and quiet spirit</u>, which is of great worth in God's sight.	1 Pet 3:1 你们作妻子的要顺服自己的丈夫；这样，若有不信从道理的丈夫，他们虽然不听道，也可以因妻子的品行被感化过来； 2 这正是因看见你们有贞洁的品行和敬畏的心。 3 你们不要以外面的辫头发，戴金饰，穿美衣为妆饰， 4 只要以里面存着长久温柔、安静的心为妆饰；这在神面前是极宝贵的。
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This is difficult to do, just as the man's task in the following scriptures is difficult:

3.2 Husband must respect his wife and think about her needs, and give himself up.

1 Pet 3:7 Husbands, in the same way be considerate as you live with your wives, and treat them with respect as the weaker partner and as heirs with you of the gracious gift of life, so that nothing will hinder your prayers.	7 你们作丈夫的也要按情理和妻子同住；因她比你软弱，与你一同承受生命之恩的，所以要敬重她。这样，便叫你们的祷告没有阻碍。
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Eph. 5:25 Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ loved the church and gave himself up for her	<u>以弗所书 5:25</u> 你们作丈夫的，要爱你们的妻子，正如基督爱教会，为教会舍己。
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3.3 How can both husband and wife fulfill this kind of love?

- We all struggle to put our anger and selfishness on the cross.
- We should be patient with our partners weaknesses, knowing that we are also easily put in a bad mood.
- There is a time to speak the truth to each other, but with grace. (while praying)
- Over time, not immediately, God will bring increased love to those who try to become like Christ.
- The overall goal of the Christian life is to please God on earth and be rewarded in heaven.
- The character you show in your marriage, may or may not make a happy marriage, but it will be rewarded in the life to come.

4. God's Holy Spirit guides and empowers transformation!

(2 Corinthians 3:18)

哥林多后书 3:18

18 And we all, who with unveiled faces contemplate **the Lord's glory**, are being transformed into his image with ever-increasing glory, which comes from the Lord, who is the Spirit.

8 我们众人既然**敞**着脸得以看见主的荣光，好像从镜子里返照，就变成主的形状，荣上加荣，如同从主的灵变成的。。

- As we **gaze** and **contemplate** the Lord's glory...(the beautiful, loving things that he does。 。 。)
- 2. We begin to be **changed** by the Spirit so that our life looks more like Jesus's life.
- 3. This happens in a **process**, from one level of the Lord's glory to the next level.
- 4. All of the **comes from the Lord's Spirit**, who guides and helps us to change our selfish ways.

Our marriages are one of the many areas that God's transformation occurs.

We should keep gazing at God's actions in scripture and let God's commands show us how to better handle the problems

Questions about the movie "Fireproof"

1. What are some of the issues Caleb and Catherine have in their marriage?
凯勒和凯瑟琳在婚姻中面对了哪些问题呢?

2. From this movie what do you think a man needs most in marriage?
看了这部电影, 你觉得男性最需要什么?

3. From this movie can you recognize a woman's primary needs?
在这部电影中你观察到女性最需要什么?

4 Caleb sees at a certain moment what love really is.
Can you describe what kind of love is needed in a marriage?
凯勒在某一瞬间看到了爱的真谛,
你认为婚姻中最需要的爱是哪一种?

5. What things might give hope for this couple?
为什么这对夫妻间有盼望?

6. We all get burnt in our marriages or relationships. How can we become a "fireman" (who puts out the fires) in our own marriage/relationship?
我们都会有被婚姻所灼烧的时候,
我们怎么能变成我们自己婚姻的“消防员”吗?